

Exp 5: Extending the Insurance Claim Request Form with Advanced Fields in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To extend the existing **Claim_Request_Form** of the application *Insurance Claim Request & Processing Management (Advanced Edition)* in Zoho Creator by incorporating all **seventeen Advanced Fields** available in the Form Builder, so that the form moves beyond basic data capture and demonstrates policy verification, witness capture, computed settlement values, file/media handling and automated claim-reference/QR generation within a real insurance-servicing use case.

2. Procedure

2.1 Problem Statement & Application Scope

The basic Claim Request Form (built earlier with the thirteen Basic Fields) captures a claimant's identity, contact details and incident description. It cannot, however, handle several real-world needs of an insurance branch: verifying policy details against a master policy database, recording multiple witness statements for one incident, computing the net payable amount after depreciation and deductible, issuing a unique scannable claim tracking reference, or accepting supporting media such as damage photographs, a repair estimate and a signed declaration.

Item	Details
Application Name	Insurance Claim Request & Processing Management (Advanced Edition)
Form Name	Claim_Request_Form (extended with Advanced Fields)
Primary Users	Policyholders / Nominees / Claims Processing Team
Report View	Claim_Request_Report (extended with computed settlement, claim reference and QR code columns)
Objective	Verify policies automatically, record witness statements, compute net payable amounts and issue scannable digital claim tracking references

2.2 Data Model & ER Diagram

The diagram below shows the internal schema built for this application. The primary form, Claim_Request_Form, extends the Basic fields with Advanced ones. The **Policies** master form is connected through the Policy_Details_Lookup field (many claims to one policy), while the **Witness_Details SubForm** stores repeating witness rows (one claim to up to four witnesses). Media fields and system-generated values are stored directly on the claim record.

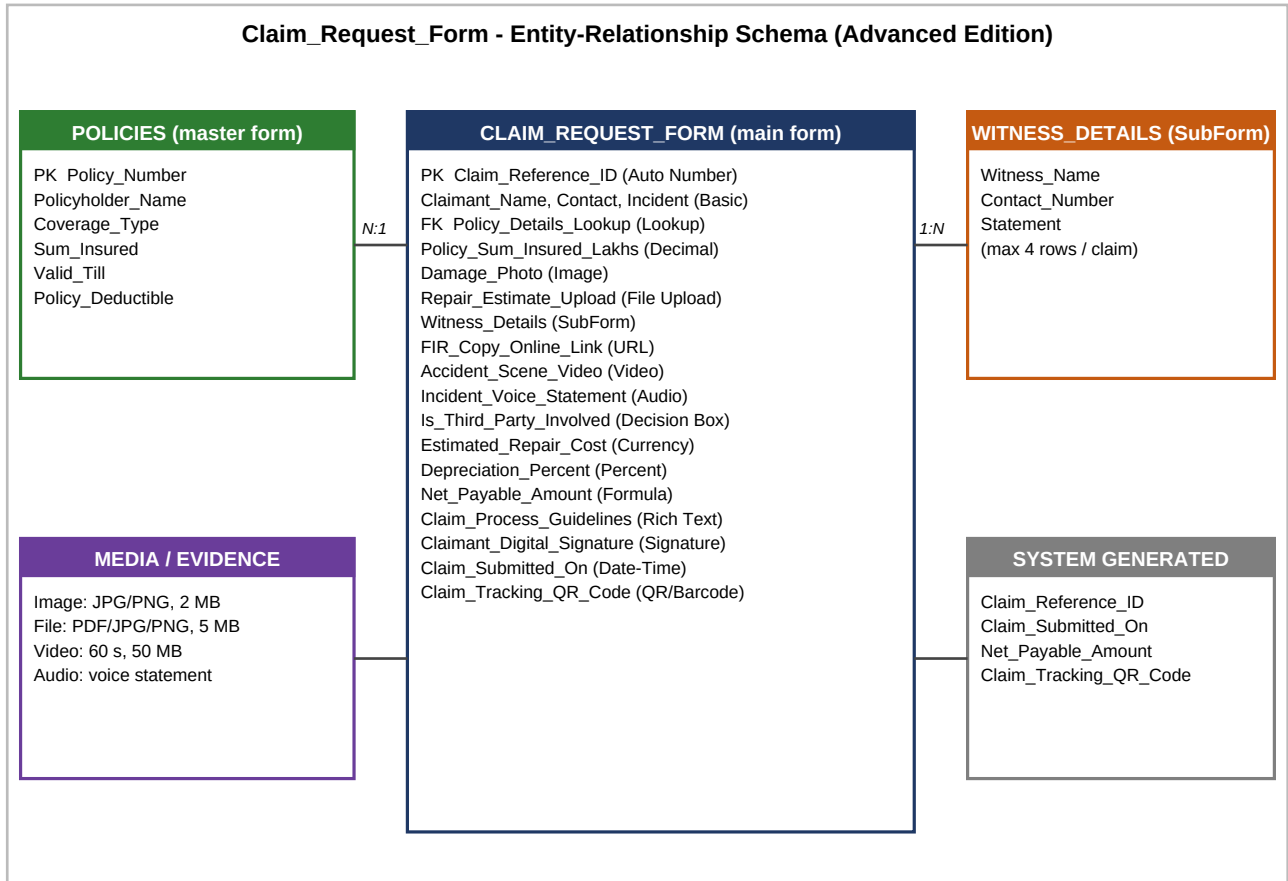


Figure 1: Entity-Relationship schema for Claim_Request_Form

2.3 Advanced Fields Used and Their Mapping

#	Advanced Field	Form Field Name	Purpose	Sample Value / Behaviour
1	Decision Box	Is_Third_Party_Involved	Quick Yes/No on whether a third party was involved	Yes / No toggle
2	Rich Text	Claim_Process_Guidelines_Display	Shows formatted guidelines (bold headings, bullets, links) in the form	"Keep all original bills. A surveyor will contact you within 48 hours."
3	URL	FIR_Copy_Online_Link	Link to an online copy of the police FIR / incident report	https://efir.tnpolice.gov.in/case/88231
4	Image	Damage_Photo	Photograph of damaged property/vehicle for preliminary assessment	damage_photo_01.jpg
5	Percent	Depreciation_Percent	Depreciation applicable to the part/asset per policy terms	20%
6	Currency	Estimated_Repair_Cost	Estimated repair/replacement cost with currency symbol	Rs. 38,000.00

#	Advanced Field	Form Field Name	Purpose	Sample Value / Behaviour
7	Decimal	Policy_Sum_Insured_Lakhs	Sum insured (in lakhs) used to check claim against policy limits	5.50
8	Date-Time	Claim_Submitted_On	Auto-records exact date and time of submission	24-Jul-2026 16:20
9	SubForm	Witness_Details	Repeating rows of witness name, contact number and statement	Row 1: Mohan K. - 9876543210 - Saw the collision
10	Lookup	Policy_Details_Lookup	Looks up and auto-fills coverage type, sum insured and validity from Policies	POL-2024-778812 - Comprehensive - Valid till 31-Mar-2027
11	Signature	Claimant_Digital_Signature	Digital signature confirming declaration of authenticity	Signed (drawn signature captured)
12	File Upload	Repair_Estimate_Upload	Scanned garage/repair estimate or medical bill	repair_estimate.pdf
13	Audio	Incident_Voice_Statement	Optional short voice statement by the claimant	voice_statement_01.mp3 (0:35)
14	Video	Accident_Scene_Video	Short video of accident scene / damage for the surveyor	accident_scene.mp4 (0:50)
15	Auto Number	Claim_Reference_ID	Unique sequential claim reference per submission	INS-CLM-2026-000384
16	Formula	Net_Payable_Amount	Computes net settlement: Repair Cost - (Repair Cost x Depreciation %) - Policy Deductible	Read-only, auto-computed
17	QR/Barcode	Claim_Tracking_QR_Code	Scannable QR encoding the Claim Reference ID for branch-counter tracking	QR image encoding INS-CLM-2026-000384

2.4 Extended Form Layout (Section-wise)

The following sections are added after the existing Claimant, Contact and Claim Details sections.

Section	Fields (Field Type)
E - Policy Verification & Evidence	Policy Details Lookup (Lookup); Damage Photo (Image); Repair Estimate Upload (File Upload); Policy Sum Insured in Lakhs (Decimal)
F - Witness & Media Details	Witness Details (SubForm); FIR Copy Online Link (URL); Accident Scene Video (Video, optional); Incident Voice Statement (Audio, optional)
G - Settlement Computation	Is Third Party Involved (Decision Box); Estimated Repair Cost (Currency); Depreciation Percent (Percent); Net Payable Amount (Formula, read-only)
H - Declaration & System-Generated Values	Claim Process Guidelines Display (Rich Text, read-only); Claimant Digital Signature (Signature); Claim Submitted On (Date-Time, auto); Claim Reference ID (Auto Number); Claim Tracking QR Code (QR/Barcode)

2.5 Step-by-Step Configuration in Zoho Creator

1. **Open the application** and edit Claim_Request_Form in the Form Builder.
2. **Create the master form "Policies"** with Policy_Number, Coverage_Type, Sum_Insured, Valid_Till and Policy_Deductible; add a few sample policy records.
3. **Add Section E:** drag a Lookup field (connect to Policies, enable search), then Image, File Upload and Decimal fields.
4. **Add Section F:** drag a SubForm (Witness_Name, Contact_Number, Statement), then URL, Video and Audio fields.

5. **Add Section G:** add Decision Box, Currency (INR) and Percent fields, then a Formula field for Net_Payable_Amount.
6. **Add Section H:** add the Rich Text block, Signature, Date-Time, Auto Number and QR/Barcode fields.
7. **Set the validations** listed in Section 2.6 under each field's properties.
8. **Create a Lookup fill-on-select** action (Deluge/On User Input) so coverage type, sum insured and validity auto-fill after a policy is chosen.
9. **Update the report** Claim_Request_Report to display Net_Payable_Amount, Claim_Reference_ID and the QR code.
10. **Access the application**, open the form preview, submit at least two sample records and capture screenshots.

2.6 Validation & Configuration Rules

Field	Rule
Policy_Details_Lookup	Connected to the master Policies form; staff type-ahead search and select instead of free text
Witness_Details (SubForm)	Minimum 0 and maximum 4 rows per claim
Repair_Estimate_Upload	Accept PDF, JPG, PNG only; maximum 5 MB
Damage_Photo	Accept JPG and PNG only; maximum 2 MB
Accident_Scene_Video	Maximum duration 60 seconds; maximum 50 MB
Depreciation_Percent	Value range 0 to 50
Estimated_Repair_Cost	Non-negative values only; formatted in INR
Net_Payable_Amount	Read-only; recalculated whenever Estimated Repair Cost or Depreciation Percent changes
Claim_Reference_ID	Prefix "INS-CLM-", current year, 6-digit auto-incrementing sequence
Claim_Tracking_QR_Code	Auto-generated immediately after Claim Reference ID is assigned on submission
Signature & Decision Box	Mandatory; the form cannot be submitted without them

Formula used: $\text{Net_Payable_Amount} = \text{Estimated_Repair_Cost} - (\text{Estimated_Repair_Cost} \times \text{Depreciation_Percent} / 100) - \text{Policy_Deductible}$. *Example:* Repair cost Rs. 38,000, depreciation 20%, deductible Rs. 1,000 gives $38,000 - 7,600 - 1,000 = \text{Rs. } 29,400$.

2.7 Workflow Summary

- Step 1: Claimant completes the basic sections (personal, contact, claim details).
- Step 2: Claims staff verify policy details through the Lookup field, which auto-fills coverage type, sum insured and validity.
- Step 3: Witnesses, if any, are added as rows in the Witness_Details SubForm.
- Step 4: Claimant uploads the damage photo, repair estimate and, optionally, a scene video and voice statement.
- Step 5: Claimant indicates third-party involvement; Estimated Repair Cost, Depreciation Percent and the computed Net Payable Amount are displayed.
- Step 6: Claimant reads the Claim Process Guidelines and provides the Digital Signature.
- Step 7: On Submit, Zoho Creator generates the Claim Reference ID, timestamps Claim Submitted On and creates the QR code.

Step 8: The claims team reviews Claim_Request_Report, verifies documents and witness statements, confirms settlement and uses the QR code for status tracking.

3. Output (Screenshots)

Insert the following screenshots in the lab record:

- (a) Extended form in Form Builder showing all 17 Advanced Fields.
- (b) Live preview of the form including the SubForm and the computed Net Payable Amount.
- (c) At least two sample submitted records showing the auto-generated Claim Reference ID and QR code in Claim_Request_Report.

Screenshot (a): Form Builder

Screenshot (b): Form Preview

Screenshot (c): Report with Claim ID and QR

4. Learning Outcomes

- Understand the purpose and correct use case of each Advanced Field in Zoho Creator.
- Configure Lookup fields for cross-form data verification.
- Use SubForms to capture repeating, witness-based data within a single submission.
- Use Formula and Auto Number fields to automate calculations and unique identifiers.
- Configure file-based fields (Image, File Upload, Audio, Video, Signature) with format and size restrictions.
- Apply QR/Barcode fields for real-world claim tracking and process automation.

5. Result

The Claim_Request_Form was successfully extended with all seventeen Advanced Fields. Policy verification through Lookup, witness capture through SubForm, automatic Net Payable computation, and auto-generated Claim Reference ID and QR code were implemented and verified with sample

submissions.